

# Robin Rowland

PhD Candidate  
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## Key skills

Data management • Statistical analysis (R) • Project coordination • Stakeholder engagement • Scientific communication

Wildlife ecologist with demonstrated experience in data management, technical analysis and reporting, and stakeholder engagement across academic, government, and community partners. Skilled in maintaining large ecological datasets and communicating complex scientific information to diverse audiences. Proven project coordination and committee experience, and strong statistical analysis skills in R.

## Education

- 2023 - present     **Doctor of Philosophy**, University of the Sunshine Coast  
Thesis: Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats  
*Anticipated completion: January 2026*
- 2012 - 2016     **Bachelor of Arts (Honours Program), Animal Behaviour**, Eckerd College, USA

## Relevant experience

- 2023 - present     **PhD Researcher**, University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD
- Lead a research project examining the effects of urbanisation and roost environments on insectivorous bat health and physiology
  - Developed an open-access continental-scale database of Australian bat roost associations and a complementary functional-trait database
  - Work with private landholders, non-profit organisations, and state and local government, and communicate findings to stakeholders
  - Mentor and assist with supervision and experimental design of six student research projects (three undergraduate, three honours)
- 2024 - present     **Student Scholar**, GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks
- Participate in international working groups and meetings involving bat researchers, conservation practitioners, and other specialists
  - Collaborate on a global review of Data Deficient bat species, including the creation, cleaning, and management of a large citation database
  - Contribute to the development of globally relevant scientific communication guidelines as part of the Global Bat Communication Guidelines Working Group

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| 2023 - present      | <p><b>Tutor</b>, University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD</p> <p><i>ANM100 - Animal Ecology Field Course</i> (×4)</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Deliver course content on bat acoustics and provide support and instruction for first-year university students during a field course on North Stradbroke Island (Minjerribah)</li> <li>• Demonstrate ecological field techniques, including transects, acoustic monitoring, and animal identification, across diverse terrains and adapt delivery to varied student abilities</li> </ul> <p><i>ANM103 - Animal Form and Function</i> (×4)   <i>ENS222 - Terrestrial Vertebrate Diversity &amp; Ecology</i> (×3)</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Instruct university students in laboratory techniques and scientific writing, moderate discussions, and mark assignments within short turnaround periods</li> <li>• Lead student groups on annual vertebrate identification field trips</li> </ul> |
| 2017 - 2023         | <p><b>Outreach Coordinator</b>, Tamborine Mountain Glow Worm Caves, QLD</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Liaised with tour and school groups, production companies, and news agencies to deliver tailored wildlife conservation information in a fast-paced environment</li> <li>• Represented the company at academic conferences and communicated with the public and scientific community through emails, reports, and reviews</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Aug 2019 - Dec 2022 | <p><b>Literature Database Manager &amp; Website Editor</b>, Wildlife Tourism Australia</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Sorted and standardised an existing literature database to improve accessibility, integrated an embedded Zotero library, and provided ongoing updates for new publications</li> <li>• Maintained and updated website content to reflect information and updates from individual member sites</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 2016                | <p><b>Research Intern</b>, Busch Gardens Animal Research Center, USA</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Collected and analysed behavioural, physiological, and parasite data on a range of mammalian and avian species</li> <li>• Coordinated with other researchers to design novel experiments and deliver results from multiple parallel projects to internal and external stakeholders</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 2015                | <p><b>Research Intern</b>, Savannah State University Dolphin Science Lab, USA</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Collected behavioural and environmental data on bottlenose dolphin individuals during weekly field surveys and assisted with database updates and maintenance</li> <li>• After the internship concluded, worked remotely with the laboratory to complete a study examining injury rates in local dolphin populations</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

## Service roles

|                |                                                                             |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026           | <b>Bats in Buildings Working Group Member</b> , NA                          |
| 2026           | <b>UniSC HDR Retreat Organising Committee</b> , NA                          |
| 2023 - present | <b>Treasurer</b> , UniSC Ecological Society                                 |
| 2020 - 2024    | <b>Committee Member</b> , Wildlife Preservation Society of QLD - Scenic Rim |
| 2019 - present | <b>Wildlife Rescuer &amp; Workshop Co-Lead</b> , Bats Queensland            |

## Grants and awards

|      |                                                                                                                                        |
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| 2025 | <p><b>Data Deficient Bat Working Group Funding</b> (21,851), GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks</p> <p>Co-investigator</p> |
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| 2024        | <b>Establishing vital roost characteristics to facilitate urban insectivorous bat conservation</b> (49,586), WIRES National Research Grant<br>Co-investigator |
| 2023 - 2026 | <b>Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland</b> (20,720), Holsworth Wildlife Research Endowment<br>Lead Author                                             |
| 2023        | <b>Radio Transmitters for Insectivorous Bats</b> (2,720), Holohil Transmitter Grant Program<br>Lead Author                                                    |
| 2023        | <b>Bat Roost Identification</b> (1,197), Wildlife Acoustics Scientific Product Grant<br>Lead Author                                                           |
| 2021        | <b>Wildlife Corridors in the Scenic Rim</b> (49,000), Landcare Led Bushfire Recovery Grants<br>Lead Author                                                    |
| 2020        | <b>Educational Workshops and Events for Bat Carers</b> (1,950), Logan EnviroGrants<br>Lead Author                                                             |
| 2020        | <b>ICUs for Bat Carers Capacity Building</b> (9,900), Logan EnviroGrants<br>Lead Author                                                                       |

## Invited presentations

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| Apr-2026 | <b>GBatNet 'My Field for Dummies' Online Series</b><br>Urban Bat Ecology                                          |
| Oct-2025 | <b>University of the Third Age Sunshine Coast</b><br>Bats in Our Backyards - Get to Know Our Nocturnal Neighbours |
| Jul-2025 | <b>UniSC Ecological Society</b><br>Introduction to Zotero and Scientific Citations                                |
| Sep-2024 | <b>UniSC Ecological Society</b><br>Ecological Careers Workshop                                                    |
| Aug-2024 | <b>UniSC Ecological Society</b><br>Introduction to Scientific Writing                                             |

## Presentations and posters

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| Aug-2026 | <b>Physiological Tools for Monitoring Urban Impacts at The Roost Level in Insectivorous Bats</b><br>Talk - Joint Conference of the Australian Mammal Society and Australasian Bat Society, Australia                  |
| Dec-2025 | <b>Stressed Out Bats: Developing Tools to Monitor Physiological Stress in Three Insectivorous Species</b><br>Talk - Australian and New Zealand Society for Comparative Physiology and Biochemistry Meeting, Australia |
| Nov-2025 | <b>Bats Are in The Building: Understanding Anthropogenic Roost Selection Through Habitat Models</b><br>Talk - Ecological Society of Australia Conference, Australia                                                   |

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| Aug-2025 | <b>No One Size Fits All: Exploring Anthropogenic Roost Selection Across an Urban Gradient in South East Queensland</b><br>Talk - 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia                                     |
| Aug-2025 | <b>The System Works: Post-Release Survival of Rehabilitated Insectivorous Bats in Australia</b><br>Talk - 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia                                                            |
| Jul-2025 | <b>Home Is Where the Bats Are: Bats in Man-Made Structures in South East Queensland</b><br>Talk - Animal Ecology Seminar Series, The University of the Sunshine Coast, Australia                                           |
| Oct-2024 | <b>Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, A Public Dataset</b><br>Poster - North American Bat Society Conference, Mexico                                                                                       |
| Jul-2024 | <b>Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, A Public Dataset</b><br>Poster - School of Science, Technology and Engineering Research Conference, Best Student Poster                                              |
| Apr-2024 | <b>From Rugs to Rocky Overhangs: Diverse Microclimates of Natural and Anthropogenic Bat Roosts in South East Queensland</b><br>Talk - 21st Australasian Bat Society Conference, Australia                                  |
| Apr-2024 | <b>Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, A Public Dataset</b><br>Poster - Australasian Bat Society Conference, Australia, Runner Up Student Poster                                                            |
| Nov-2023 | <b>Working with Bat Landlords to Study the Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland</b><br>Talk - Australian Citizen Science Conference, Australia                                           |
| Feb-2020 | <b>The Success of a Wildlife Corridor on Tamborine Mountain and the Value of Landcare</b><br>Talk - Wildlife Preservation Society Scenic Rim Corridors Workshop, Australia                                                 |
| Dec-2019 | <b>The Scenic Rim and Its Potential Role as an Ethical Wildlife Tourism Destination</b><br>Talk - The Scenic Rim as an Environmentally-Sustainable International Wildlife Destination Workshop, Australia                  |
| Oct-2018 | <b>Can Glow-worm Ecotourism Lead to Increased Conservation Knowledge and Positive Intentions Towards Glow-worms in the Wild?</b><br>Talk - 5th National Wildlife Tourism Australia Conference, Australia                   |
| Apr-2016 | <b>Do Common Bottlenose Dolphins That Interact with Humans Experience Greater Rates of Anthropogenic Injuries?</b><br>Talk - Southeast and Mid-Atlantic Marine Mammal Symposium, USA, Best Undergraduate Oral Presentation |
| Apr-2015 | <b>Can Mongoose Lemurs Recognize Individual Humans?</b><br>Poster - 23rd International Conference on Comparative Cognition, USA                                                                                            |

## Science communication

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| Jan-2026 | <b>ABC Sunshine Coast Radio, Wide Bay, Southern Queensland</b> , Commenting on Noosa Flying Fox Mass Entanglement Event |
| Jan-2026 | <b>ABC Sunshine Coast Radio</b> , Commenting on Annual Influx of Little Red Flying Foxes in the Region                  |
| Aug-2024 | <b>ABC Sunshine Coast, ABC Australia</b> , <a href="#">Commenting on Arson Incident on Mooloolah Valley Bat Colony</a>  |

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| Jul-2024 | <b>TalkECO Podcast</b> , <a href="#">Microbats</a> , <a href="#">Chicken Nuggets</a> , <a href="#">Stress and Wildlife Rescue!</a> |
| Feb-2024 | <b>Sunshine Coast News</b> , <a href="#">Study to Help Save Mini Bats That Fly Under the Radar</a>                                 |
| Feb-2024 | <b>ABC Sunshine Coast Breakfast Radio</b> , Research to Save Tiny Bats from Housing Crisis                                         |
| Jul-2023 | <b>Cosmos Magazine</b> , <a href="#">Little Forest Bats: Earth's Tiniest Heroes (Australian Mammal of the Year Profile)</a>        |

## Outreach

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| Mar-2026 | <b>Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk</b> , Moreton Bay Council                                                              |
| Mar-2026 | <b>Invited Speaker and Exhibit Consultant, Queensland Museum Bat Night Market Exhibit</b> , World Science Festival Brisbane  |
| Nov-2025 | <b>Bats in Buildings on the Sunshine Coast, Maleny Bat Night</b> , Sunshine Coast Council                                    |
| Oct-2025 | <b>Bats of the Sunshine Coast Workshop and Bat Walk</b> , Mooloolah River Landcare                                           |
| Oct-2025 | <b>Bats in Your Backyard: Crash Course to the Bats of SEQ ('What's Brewing Behind the Dunes' Series)</b> , Cooloom CoastCare |
| Nov-2024 | <b>Bat Workshop and Spotlighting Walk</b> , UniSC Ecological Society                                                         |
| Oct-2024 | <b>Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats, Maleny Bat Night</b> , Sunshine Coast Council                              |
| Oct-2024 | <b>Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk</b> , Moreton Bay Council                                                              |
| Sep-2024 | <b>Bat Call Walk and Workshop Leader</b> , Springfield Lakes Nature Centre                                                   |
| May-2024 | <b>Bats and Forests: We Need Bats More Than You Think!</b> , Maleny Wood Expo, Maleny, QLD                                   |
| Apr-2024 | <b>Bat Call Walk Leader, Microbat Discovery Walk Series</b> , Brisbane Catchments Network                                    |
| Oct-2023 | <b>Sunshine Coast Citizen Science Bat Walk</b> , Sunshine Coast BioBlitz                                                     |

## Skills and certifications

- Statistical analysis in R - linear modelling, mixed modelling, and spatial modelling with temporal and spatial autocorrelation (UQ R Course)
- Operate and Maintain 4WD Vehicle (RIIVEH305F)
- Provide Advanced Resuscitation and Oxygen Therapy First Aid (HLTAID015)
- Provide Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation - CPR (HLTAID009)

## Referees

**Dr Clare Stawski** (Primary Supervisor) - Senior Lecturer, University of the Sunshine Coast  
[cstawski@usc.edu.au](mailto:cstawski@usc.edu.au) |

**Dr Alexis Levensgood** (Co-Supervisor and Field Course Leader) - Research Fellow, University of the Sunshine Coast  
[alevengo@usc.edu.au](mailto:alevengo@usc.edu.au) |